Help Across Dad's Day

A worksheet for what he does himself, where he gets a hand, and who gives it.

Ask three relatives how much help Dad gets and you'll hear three answers. Mostly that's because each of you sees a different part of his week.

Fill this in over a week or two, a few lines at a time, with Dad beside you if he's willing. Write what happens now, task by task, and keep the things he does himself on the page. Where nobody knows, write “not recorded” and leave it.

Morning

Getting up, washing, dressing, breakfast, the morning pills. For each one: does Dad do it himself, or does someone lend a hand, and who?

FOR EXAMPLE Up by 6:30, showers and dresses himself. Makes his own coffee and toast. Takes his pills from the box Linda fills on Sundays.

Through the day

Meals, the house, the yard, errands, appointments, the mail, getting out to see people.

FOR EXAMPLE Drives himself to the barber and the diner. Marcus takes him grocery shopping on Saturdays. Mrs. Ortiz next door brings in the trash cans.

Evening and night

Supper, locking up, getting to bed, and anything that happens overnight. If nobody in the family has seen this part of his day, say so.

FOR EXAMPLE Heats his own supper. Tracy phones around eight. Nobody has been there overnight, so the nights are not recorded.

How often, and how you know

Next to any help you've listed, note how often it happens, but only where a calendar shows it or someone has confirmed it. Otherwise write “not recorded.”

FOR EXAMPLE Grocery shopping: every Saturday, from Marcus's calendar. Rides to the eye doctor: not recorded. We think twice last year.

Getting around and keeping in touch

How Dad moves around the house and gets out, and what he uses to hear, see, read and use the phone. Write what you've seen.

FOR EXAMPLE Takes the stairs with a hand on the rail. Wears his hearing aids most days. Prefers a phone call to a text.

What each helper can keep doing

Ask each person who helps, and write it in their words. It describes their week as it is now. It isn't a promise.

FOR EXAMPLE Marcus: “Saturdays are fine, except when I'm away for work, about one in six.” Mrs. Ortiz: haven't asked.

Before you put it away

- Write today's date at the top, and the name of everyone who added to it.
- Ask Dad to read it. He'll correct things you got wrong.
- Leave every “not recorded” where it is. It tells the next reader what hasn't been looked at.

What this shows you

Three things: what Dad does himself, where a hand is already part of his week, and which parts nobody has written down. It doesn't show how much care he needs, now or later. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and it says nothing about what comes next. Questions about whether he should have someone with him, or about any health service, go to the people who assess him.

Ready for the next step?

You've walked through Dad's day and written down what's true this month. The care interview covers the same ground and the areas a worksheet leaves out, including the ones that are fine right now, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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